Afghan Peace Jirga in April 2010 with support from India. On 5 September 2010, the Afghan High Peace Council (HPC) was inaugurated, and in November the same year, India was seen working closely with Kabul at the Heart of Asia conference from which it had been excluded on Pakistan's behest earlier.[105] In May 2011, Manmohan Singh paid a visit to Kabul to set the ball rolling on the India-Afghanistan bilateral Strategic Partnership Agreement that was signed in New Delhi five months later in October 2011. Though Burhanuddin Rabbani, the first head of the HPC was assassinated on 20 September 2011, allegedly by militants belonging to the Quetta *shura*, the reconciliation process continued.[106] In November 2011 New Delhi extensively contributed to the Istanbul process with Karzai publicly praising Kabul's deepening friendship with India and Turkey as a model for how Afghanistan sought its future relationships with other regional partners'.[107]

India's diplomatic activism on Afghanistan was accompanied by increasingly worsening relations between the US and Pakistan. 2011 was one of the worst years in the history of US-Pakistan relations. On 27 January, a former US army officer and CIA contractor Raymond A Davis shot two people dead in the middle of a street in Lahore, unleashing a diplomatic storm.[108] Adding insult to injury, on 2 May a team of US Navy SEALS conducted a successful raid in Abbottabad, killing Al Qaeda chief Osama bin Laden. Though the debate on whether Pakistan's security agencies knew of bin Laden's presence on their soil is far from settled, the incident marked a historical low in US-Pakistan bilateral relations. If this was not enough, two NATO Apache helicopters, an AC-130 gunship, and two F-15E Eagle fighter jets entered Pakistan's territory in the Salala sector of the Mohmand agency at 2 AM on 26 November 2011, and destroyed two Pakistani army check-posts 'Volcano' and 'Boulder' killing 28 Pakistani soldiers and wounding 12 others.[109] An enraged Pakistan responded by closing all NATO supplies to Afghanistan via its territory and refused to participate in the December 2011 Bonn Conference. Though Islamabad's position was communicated throughout the conference, the diplomatic boycott undermined the effectiveness of the conference (but was highly appreciated by India).

It was a 'remarkable rebound' says Mukhopadhaya. As Pakistan's relations with the US took a downturn, India, with Karzai's support, successfully muddied